

UAH Graduate School Thesis, Dissertation, and DNP Project Manual

Website:

<https://www.uah.edu/graduate/resources/thesis-dissertation-and-dnp-project/thesis-manual>

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GRADUATE SCHOOL

THE UNIVERSITY OF ALABAMA IN HUNTSVILLE

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INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the UAH thesis /dissertation/DNP project manual. This manual, in conjunction with the templates provided, will serve as your guide to submitting your master's thesis, PhD dissertation, or DNP project. These projects are capstone works completed toward the end of a graduate degree program. A master's thesis is the capstone project associated with a master's degree, a doctoral dissertation is the original, creative project associated with a doctoral degree, and a DNP project is the final project submitted as part of a Doctor of Nursing Practice degree. Theses, dissertations, and DNP projects are typically in the form of books written by students on behalf of the university. They thus typically follow rules and guidelines established by the university and the associated academic discipline, following best practices with regards to writing, presentation, and citation. Academic guidelines and high standards are set to ensure that the best representation of yourself, your research advisor, your academic program, and the University of Alabama in Huntsville is provided. When your thesis / dissertation / DNP project has been approved and published, it will be one of your outstanding achievements.

APPROVAL PROCESS

The following procedure will be used to submit your thesis, dissertation, or DNP project. Follow all deadlines published on the [Graduate School website](#). If your thesis/dissertation contains Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI), you must follow a revised submission process; consult the [Graduate School website](#) for details.

- 1) Student applies for graduation.
- 2) Research Advisor or Committee Chair accepts a thesis/dissertation/DNP project draft.
- 3) Student schedules defense/final presentation with at least two weeks' notice. The defense/final presentation must be completed by the deadline published on the [Graduate School's website](#).
- 4) Student gives accepted draft to committee members for review.
- 5) Student presents thesis/dissertation/DNP project on scheduled defense date.
 - a. If student passes, proceed to step 6.
 - b. If student passes conditionally, student continues work on thesis/dissertation/DNP project and submits revised draft to the committee by the required date. If the date to complete the conditional requirements prevents the student from meeting the remaining thesis/dissertation/DNP project deadlines, the student will register for a subsequent semester (minimum of 3 credit hours of 699/799 or 739 DNP Project). Department completes step 6. The subsequent steps will only apply after the student has successfully resolved the conditional pass.
 - c. If student fails, student consults with Research Advisor, Committee Chair, Department Chair, and College Dean. Department completes step 6. The subsequent steps do not apply.
- 6) Department submits the [Report of Examination/Defense](#) to the Graduate School.
- 7) Department submits the separate Thesis/Dissertation/DNP Project [Signature Form](#). The Quali Build Signature Form will automatically be routed to all of the signatories listed on the form in addition to the Department Chair, College Dean, and Graduate Dean.

All parties with the exception of the Graduate Dean* must approve and sign the Thesis/Dissertation/DNP Signature Form by the [deadline](#) published on the Graduate School website. The student will receive emails from Quali at various points in the Signature Form workflow; these will include updates on the status of the form and directions for required actions (including ProQuest).
- 8) Student uploads thesis/dissertation/DNP project to ProQuest ETD by the deadline published on the

[Graduate School website.](#)

- 9) Student copyedits thesis/dissertation/DNP project in ProQuest with feedback from the UAH Graduate School copyeditor.

*The Graduate Dean will sign the Signature Form after the student completes the copyediting process.

- a. Student graduates in the current semester if copyedits have been completed by noon on the last day of final examinations as published online in the UAH academic calendar.
- b. If copyedits have not been completed by noon on the last day of final exams, the student applies for 0-3 credits of 699/799 (739 DNP Project) and graduates at the end of the subsequent semester. International students must consult their international student advisor to determine the minimum number of credits and documentation needed to maintain their visa status. Enrollment in the 0-credit option of 699/799 requires extenuating circumstances and the Graduate Dean's approval. Use the 0-credit request form on the [Graduate School website.](#)

UPLOADING TO PROQUEST

Theses, dissertations, and DNP projects are to be submitted through ProQuest ETD.

Only submit your manuscript *after* the Graduate School receives your completed Signature Form.

Carefully follow the directions provided by the Graduate School in an email notification.

To upload the manuscript to ProQuest ETD and begin the copyediting process, the student must:

1. Go to this link: <https://www.etdadmin.com/main/home?siteId=445>
2. Set up an account.
3. Enter the required information. Please refer to the detailed directions you received.
4. Upload the manuscript only (not the signature form), and submit it for publication.

Please remember to convert your manuscript to PDF format before uploading it to ProQuest; ProQuest will only accept PDF format. It is essential to review the PDF for potential formatting issues before you upload it to ProQuest.

ProQuest will guide you through submission in a step-by-step, user-friendly process. If you have simple questions, ProQuest's "Resources and Guidelines" tab contains helpful FAQs regarding both submission and technical support. More technical issues can be resolved by contacting ProQuest's customer service from the online submission webpage.

The following link provides answers to frequently asked questions about uploading to ProQuest ETD:

https://support.proquest.com/s/article/ETD-Administrator-Frequently-Asked-Questions?language=en_US

The student should be sure to check the ProQuest account and the email address associated with it for updates and requests for revisions from the UAH Graduate School copyeditor. The student must finish the copyediting process and receive the Graduate Dean's signature by the last day of final examinations as published online in the academic calendar; otherwise, the student will not graduate in that term.

TEMPLATE AND TUTORIAL LINKS

All submissions must follow the guidelines in the current manual. To access optional, easy-to-use templates that meet the formatting requirements explained in this guide, please double-click the appropriate link below. These templates also serve as an example of what your thesis/dissertation/DNP project should look like.

If you will produce a technical document, we recommend that you use the LaTeX template.

If you require greater formatting flexibility, we recommend that you use the Word template.

DNP students should use the template provided by their program.

[Microsoft Word Template](#) – After opening the document, select File→Download→Microsoft Word (.docx). **Do not try to edit or save as a Google Doc.**

[LaTeX Template](#) – If you do not currently have an account with Overleaf, you will need to register for a free account after clicking on the link in order to view and edit the LaTeX file. This template works best when used online in Overleaf. Begin with this template instead of importing into it.

[LaTeX Tutorial](#) -- If you are unfamiliar with navigating LaTeX, click the link below to view a short tutorial video that will help you to get started.

ORDER AND COMPONENTS

Front Matter

Title Page (Required)

The title page should be the same font type as the rest of the dissertation. Although it is counted as page i, its page number should not appear at the bottom of the page. The title page must contain the following in this order:

1. **Title:** This should be centered, in boldface, and in all capital letters with a one-inch top margin. If the title extends to two or more lines, single-space between the lines of the title.
Exception: You should use appropriate formatting if required by the text such as a chemical formula or scientific name (*e.g.*, **THE HEALTH BENEFITS OF SODIUM BICARBONATE – NaHCO₃**).
2. **Your name:** Your name should appear two double-spaces below the title, centered, and in boldface.
3. **Document Type:** “**A THESIS,**” “**A DISSERTATION,**” or “**A DNP PROJECT**” should be one double-space below your name, centered, in boldface, and in all capital letters.
4. **Statement and Degree:** One double-space below the document type, write the following statement on two lines, centered, and in boldface:
Line one: “**Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements**”
Line two: “**for the degree of**” This statement should be followed immediately on the same line with the name of your degree (*e.g.*, **Master of Science**).
5. **In:** The word “**in**” should be below the degree, centered, in boldface, and in all lower-case letters.
6. **Program:** The name of your program should be below “**in,**” centered, and in boldface with appropriate capitalization (*e.g.*, **Aerospace Systems Engineering**).
7. **To:** The word “**to**” should be below the department, centered, in boldface, and in all lower-case letters.
8. **The Graduate School:** The words “**The Graduate School**” should be below “**to,**” centered and in boldface. If you are earning a joint degree with another university or other universities, add an “**s**” to School to make it plural (*e.g.*, **The Graduate Schools**).
9. **Of:** The word “**of**” should be below the Graduate School, centered, in boldface, and in all lower-case letters.
10. **University:** **The University of Alabama in Huntsville** should be below “**of,**” centered and in boldface. If you are earning a joint degree with another university or other universities, list the additional universities as well.
11. **Graduation Month and Year:** Your graduation month and four-digit year should be below the university name, centered and in boldface (*e.g.*, **May 2022**). Please fully spell out the month.
12. **Approved by:** The words “**Approved by:**” should be below the university name, in boldface, and aligned at the left margin. It should be followed by a colon. It should begin with a capital “**A**” followed by all lower-case letters. The approval section should appear at the bottom of the title page. Adjust the spacing between the graduation month and year and this line so that the last approval name is at the bottom of the page.

13. **Approval Names:** List the names of the professors that approved your thesis/dissertation/DNP project followed by a comma and their titles (*e.g.*, Dr. Jon Hakkila, Graduate Dean). Include your research advisor, committee chair (list on separate lines if different), all committee members, department chair, college dean, and graduate dean in that order. Single space between names. **If you are in an interdisciplinary program, the Graduate School Dean serves as the College Dean for your program. You will list the Graduate School Dean twice in the approval list on separate lines, once in the role of College Dean and again in the role of Graduate Dean.**

Abstract (Required)

The abstract page(s) should be titled **Abstract**. The title should be centered with a one-inch top margin and in boldface.

Below the abstract page title, type your thesis/dissertation/DNP project title. It should be centered, in all-capital letters, and in boldface. If your title extends to two or more lines, use single-spacing within the title. Below your project title, your name should appear centered and in boldface. Below your name should appear the following statement on two single-spaced lines, centered, and in boldface:

Line one: **A thesis/dissertation/DNP project submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements**

Line two: **for the degree of [your degree]**

Below the above statement, provide your program, centered, and in boldface with appropriate capitalization (*e.g.*, **Materials Science**). Below the program, type the name of the university centered and in boldface (*e.g.*, **The University of Alabama in Huntsville**). If you earned a joint degree, include the name of the other university or universities. Below the university name(s), type your graduation month and year, centered, and in boldface.

One double-space below the graduation month and year, begin the body of your abstract. The body of your abstract should be double-spaced and left-aligned with a 1.5 left margin. The abstract must be limited to one paragraph. Remember to indent the beginning of the paragraph.

Please Note: There is a strict word limit for abstracts. **Thesis abstracts should not exceed 150 words, and dissertation/DNP abstracts should not exceed 350 words.**

Number with the lowercase Roman numeral ii at the bottom center of the page with a ½ inch bottom margin.

Rights and Responsibilities (Required)

This page contains two sections. It does not have a heading and should not appear in the Table of Contents.

Section 1 (required): The top section is a disclosure statement regarding the use of generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the preparation and writing of your manuscript. It should be double-spaced and left-justified. Ensure that you are following your graduate program/department's AI guidelines. Your committee chair can provide these for you. If your program does not have their own guidelines, you must follow the [Graduate School's AI guidelines](#).

Choose the appropriate statement below and replace the words in brackets with the relevant information. Delete all brackets.

[**Statement 1**] Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) was not used in the writing of this [thesis/dissertation/DNP project].

[**Statement 2**] I have followed the approved guidelines of my graduate program and the UAH Graduate School for the use of generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) in the writing of this [thesis/dissertation/DNP project]. The following generative AI tools were used for the associated purpose(s) listed after each tool:

[Tool 1] [purpose]

[Tool 2] [purpose]

[Tool 3] [purpose]

[Tool 4] [purpose]

Section 2 (optional): The copyright section should only be filled out if you have registered your manuscript for a copyright. If you have not registered for a copyright, leave this section blank. Even if it is blank, the page should still be numbered at the bottom center with a ½ inch margin and a lowercase Roman numeral. If you have registered for a copyright, fill out the page as described below:

The copyright section of this page has three components: a) the copyright symbol (©), b) your name, and c) the text, “All Rights Reserved.” Each component should be on its own line, double-spaced, and centered at the bottom of the page above the page number.

Acknowledgements (Optional*)

The acknowledgements page should be titled **Acknowledgements**. The title should be in boldface and centered with a one-inch top margin.

Begin your acknowledgements one double-spaced line below the title and use 12-point font. Indent the beginning of each new paragraph and use double-spacing throughout. Number with lowercase Roman numerals at the bottom center of the page(s) with a ½ inch bottom margin.

It is polite and respectful to acknowledge your scholarly debts by thanking those who have provided intellectual guidance, facilities, or financial support for your project; thus, you thank those who have been significantly involved in your work.

***If you received funding or other resources from any agencies for your research, you must acknowledge their contributions. You also should cite any individual or institution who has granted you permission to reprint material.**

You may conclude your acknowledgments with a dedication to thank family or friends rather than using a separate dedication page. A separate dedication page is optional; if you choose to include one, title it **Dedication** (use the same heading style as for the acknowledgements page) , number with lowercase Roman numerals at the bottom center of the page, and list the dedication in the Table of Contents.

Your acknowledgments should be brief and consistent in tone with a formal publication.

Table of Contents (Required)

The Table of Contents page(s) should be titled **Table of Contents**. The title should be centered, boldfaced, in title case and with a one-inch top margin.

Entries should begin one double-spaced line below the title and in 12-point font. Front matter headings, chapter titles, and back matter headings should be in boldface. Subheadings within chapters should not be in boldface in the table of contents (although they will be bold where they appear in the body). Use progressive indentations for the chapter titles and subheadings.

The Table of Contents should include all items in your thesis/dissertation/DNP project except the title page and copyright page. All entries should include leader dots that extend from the end of the title to the page number. Page numbers should be aligned with the far-right margin. For multi-line entries, carriage returns should be used to ensure that the titles do not extend all the way to the right margin where the page number are (*i.e.*, the titles should not overlap the page numbers). Entries that extend to two or more lines should be single-spaced, but double-spacing should be used between entries. Capitalize only the first letter of each word required by your chosen style. Use consistent capitalization for all headings, titles, and subheadings.

Number with lowercase Roman numerals at the bottom center of the page with a ½ inch bottom margin.

List of Figures (Required, if applicable)

The List of Figures page(s) should be titled **List of Figures**. The title should be centered and in boldface. Entries should begin one double-spaced line below the title. Only include the figure titles and not the entire figure caption. If your figure does not include a clear title, you may use the first sentence of the caption as the title. Entries should be formatted similarly to entries in the table of contents (see above).

Use consistent capitalization for all titles.

Number with lowercase Roman numerals at the bottom center of the page with a ½ inch bottom margin.

List of Tables (Required, if applicable)

The List of Tables page(s) should be titled **List of Tables**. The title should be centered and in boldface.

Entries should begin one double-space line below the title. Only include the table titles and not the entire table caption. If your table does not include a clear title, you may use the first sentence of the caption as the title. Entries should be formatted similarly to entries in the table of contents (see above).

Use consistent capitalization for all titles.

Number with lowercase Roman numerals at the bottom center of the page with a ½ inch bottom margin.

List of Symbols (Optional)

The List of Symbols page(s) should be titled **List of Symbols**. The title should be centered and in boldface.

The list should be composed of two columns with centered titles. The first column should be titled **Symbol** in boldface. The second column should be titled **Description** in boldface. Below these two

column titles, list the symbols followed by their meaning/description. When applicable, list symbols in alphabetical order.

Double-space between entries but single-space within entries that extend to two or more lines. Unlike the previous lists, do not include page numbers or leader dots. Number with lowercase Roman numerals at the bottom center of the page with a ½ inch bottom margin.

List of Schemas (Optional)

An optional section called the **List of Schemas** may be included if the thesis/dissertation/DNP project contains many schemas. If included, it should be formatted in the same manner as the **List of Figures/Tables**.

List of Abbreviations / Acronyms (Optional)

An optional section called the **List of Abbreviations** (or **Acronyms**) may be included if the thesis/dissertation/DNP project contains many abbreviations or acronyms. If included, this section should be formatted in the same manner as the **List of Symbols** although the first column will be titled **Abbreviation** (or **Acronym**); entries should be listed in alphabetical order instead of by order of appearance.

Glossary (Optional)

An optional section called the **Glossary** may be included containing a list of technical terms along with their definitions. If included, this section should be formatted in the same manner as the **List of Symbols**. Here, the first column should be titled **Term** in boldface, and the page numbers where the terms first occur can be listed immediately after the description/definition.

Epigraph (Optional)

An optional section called the epigraph may be included containing a quotation or saying. This section has no title or heading. It should be listed in the Table of Contents as Epigraph. The quotation or saying should be centered on the page and related in some way to your thesis/dissertation/DNP project. The font of the quotation should be italicized and the lines double-spaced. Be sure to cite the author. Number with lowercase Roman numerals at the bottom center of the page with a ½ inch bottom margin.

Body

The body of your thesis/dissertation/DNP project should be organized into chapters. Each chapter should start on a separate page. **Chapter titles should have a two-inch top margin** and begin with the chapter heading, which consists of the word Chapter, the appropriate number, and a period (*e.g.*, **Chapter 1.**). This is followed on the same line by the chapter title (*e.g.*, **Introduction**). Chapter titles should be in boldface and centered. Capitalize only the first letter of each word required by your chosen style. Chapter titles that extend to two or more lines should be double-spaced.

All pages in the body should be numbered with Arabic numerals beginning with the number 1. All paragraphs should begin with a ½ inch indentation. It should be double-spaced throughout. The

formatting style (*e.g.*, APA, Turabian, Chicago, MLA) should be consistent throughout. Be sure to avoid widow/orphan lines, which are single lines of text at the bottom or top of a page.

You may organize content within a chapter into sections and subsections. Similarly to chapter titles, these should include a heading (*e.g.*, 1.1, A.1, 1.1.2, A.1.2, *etc.*) followed by a title. The headings and titles should be in boldface. Capitalize only the first letter of each word required by your chosen style.

Back Matter

Endnotes (Required, if applicable)

Endnotes should be included only if the documentation style you chose requires them. The endnotes page should be titled **Endnotes**. The title should be centered with a one-inch top margin and in boldface. Double-space between entries but single space within each entry.

References (Required)

This page should be titled **References** (or whatever is required by your documentation style). The title should be centered and in boldface and title case with a one-inch top margin. The entries of your references should be formatted consistently and correctly according to the documentation style that you chose. Double-space between entries and single-space within each entry.

Bibliography (Optional)

Any work not cited in the text but sufficiently relevant to bear mentioning may be listed in a bibliography following the references. This page should be titled **Bibliography**. The title should be centered with a one-inch top margin and in boldface. The entries of your bibliography should be formatted consistently and correctly according to the documentation style you chose. Double-space between entries and single-space within them.

Appendices (Optional)

Appendices should be the last component of your thesis/dissertation/DNP project. If you only have one appendix, it should be labeled **Appendix A** unless otherwise specified by your advisor. When you have multiple appendices, each appendix begins on a new page and should be labeled alphabetically (Appendix A, Appendix B, Appendix C, *etc.*). The heading should be centered and in boldface and title case with a one-inch top margin. You may include an optional title after the heading (*e.g.*, **Appendix C. Surface Plot**). Place a period after the heading and type the title on the same line. The title should be in boldface and title case. If you include figures, tables, equations, *etc.*, in an appendix, label them according to the letter of the appendix in which they appear (*e.g.*, **Figure A.1** would be the first figure in **Appendix A**).

FORMATTING GUIDELINES

Margins

Margin requirements apply not only to pages of text and to pages of front and back matter, but also to pages with figures, tables, and illustrations.

Left: 1 inch for electronic documents/online publication or 1.5 inch for hardcopy publication (all pages)

Right: 1 inch (all pages, no exceptions)

Top: 1 inch

Exceptions: The first page of a new chapter will have a two-inch top margin.

Bottom: 1 inch

Exceptions: Page numbers are ½ inch from the bottom. To avoid an isolated line at the bottom of a page, bottom margins may be one line larger in order to move the line to the next page.

Footnotes may extend one line below the bottom margin to complete a footnote on the page.

Within these margins, you may use a ragged or justified right edge; however, **we recommend the ragged right edge for practical reasons**. Justified right edges may adjust text so that punctuation and spacing, particularly in reference or bibliographic entries, will appear incorrect if printed.

Font Type and Size

The text of the entire document (excluding symbols or variable names) must use the same standard serif font (for example, CG Times, Times New Roman, or Courier). Size 12-point font should be used throughout with the following exceptions:

- Main section titles may have a slightly larger font size (*e.g.*, 14-point) for aesthetic purposes. Use your best judgment.
- Figure/table captions and footnotes should be in size 10-point font.
- You may include a photocopy of an original document in another font and/or size in an appendix.
- To meet margin requirements, a slightly smaller font size may be used only within tables and figures. If the font in a figure is too small to read, the figure caption should specify why.

Headings and subheadings should be in boldface. Latin terms such as *i.e.*, *e.g.*, *et al.*, *in vitro*, *in vivo*, and *in situ* should be italicized (the terms *i.e.*, and *e.g.*, should also always be followed by a comma). The optional epigraph should be italicized. Italicized text may be used to draw emphasis to particular phrases or sentences.

Headings and Subheadings

A hierarchy of headings and subheadings should divide chapters into sections and subsections. You may choose one of the following systems:

- Decimal system (1.1, 1.2, 1.2.1, *etc.*)
- Alphanumeric system (outline form: A.1, A.2, A.2.a)
- Heading system, which uses the placement and typography (boldface) of headline text to show hierarchy and subordination. (This system is NOT typical for a technical paper. You should speak with your research advisor before choosing this system.)

Each heading in the decimal system should be left-aligned with no indentation. Headings in the alphanumeric system should use indentations to reinforce descending groupings. Headings in the heading system should be in boldface and may be centered, indented, or left-aligned depending on the chosen style. There should be an extra space above and below all subheadings. Whichever system you choose, remain consistent throughout the entire document.

A heading should not appear alone at the bottom of a page with its text beginning on the next page. This type of formatting issue is one that word-processing programs may not detect. Each heading must be followed by text.

You may not go to a subordinate level of a heading unless you have at least two subheadings at that level. For example, you cannot have section 1.1 if there is not also section 1.2. This applies both to the body of the document as well as to the appendices.

Spacing and Indentation

The entire document should be double-spaced with the following exceptions:

- The title of your thesis/dissertation/DNP project should be single-spaced if it extends to two or more lines on the title and abstract pages.
- Single space within entries (but double-space between them) in the table of contents, list of figures, tables, symbols, equations, schemas, and abbreviations/acronyms, glossary, endnotes, references, and bibliography
- Figure and table captions should be single-spaced
- Footnotes should be single-spaced

All paragraphs should begin with a ½-inch indentation. Decimal system subheadings should **not** be indented. Alphanumeric system subheadings should be progressively indented by ½ inch to reinforce descending groupings. Headings and subheadings in the heading system may or may not be indented depending on the chosen style.

Pagination

Begin numbering with the Roman numeral ii on the abstract page. Continue using lowercase Roman numerals throughout the front matter. Switch to the Arabic number 1 on the first page of the introduction (*i.e.*, Chapter 1). Continue with Arabic numbers for the rest of the document.

Page numbers should be located at the bottom center of a page and use a ½ inch margin.

Footnotes and Endnotes

You may use footnotes and/or endnotes depending on your chosen style and the standards for your discipline. Consult with your research advisor when deciding your document style.

Footnotes should use size 10-point font, while endnotes should use the same font size as the text. They should be single-spaced within entries and double-spaced between entries. Footnotes may extend one line lower than the one-inch bottom margin.

Figures, Tables, Equations, and Schemas

Figures, tables, equations, and schemas should not exceed the margins of the document.

You must refer to a figure or table in the text before you include it.

A figure or table should begin with a heading in boldface according to its placement within the document (*e.g.*, **Figure 1.1** would be the first figure in chapter 1, and **Table A.2** would be the second table in Appendix A).

A figure/table title and optional caption should immediately follow the heading but not be in boldface. Place a period after the title and before the caption (*e.g.*, **Table B.1** Frequencies for Equal-Tempered Scale, $A_4=440$ Hz. This table shows only the first octave of the chromatic scale starting on C_0 .)

Table /figure headings, titles, and captions should be in 10-point font, single-spaced, and centered. Add an extra line of space before and after a figure or table to distinguish it from the surrounding text.

Table headings, titles, and captions should be placed above tables.

Figure headings, titles, and captions should be placed below figures.

Equations must be labeled if your thesis/dissertation/DNP project includes a list of equations. You may still label your equations even if there is no list of equations in order to reference them in the body of the manuscript. Place the number in parentheses, use regular font, and align it to the right margin either beside or directly below the equation.

Each term in an equation must be defined either before or after the equation.

Equations should always be included in a sentence and follow conventional prose and punctuation requirements; at a minimum, ensure the sentence has a subject and a verb and ends with a period.

As with all elements of your manuscript, figures, images, tables, equations, and schemas must meet web accessibility requirements.

COMMON ERRORS

- The terms *i.e.*, and *e.g.*, should be italicized and followed by a comma anywhere they appear in the document.
- The term *et al.* should be italicized, and a period should follow only the letters *al.*
- Data is a plural noun and requires a plural verb (*e.g.*, The data are incontrovertible.)
- Widow/orphan lines should be avoided throughout the dissertation. This means you should never have a single word or line of text isolated from the rest of a paragraph at the top or bottom of a page.
- Headings should not be separated from the text they introduce (*i.e.*, no headings should be alone at the bottom of a page).
- Page numbers within the Table of Contents and List of Figures/Tables should be aligned with the far-right margin.
- Leader dots should be used for all entries in the Table of Contents and List of Figures/Tables.
- All major headings (*e.g.*, List of Figures, Chapters, References, *etc.*) should begin on a new page.
- You may not go to a subordinate level of heading unless you have at least two headings at that level. For example, you cannot have section 1.1 if there is not also section 1.2. This applies both to the body of the document as well as to the appendices.
- Avoid using the pronoun “we” in the manuscript abstract and any place it could lead to confusion in regard to your role as the principal researcher/author of the work. It is acceptable to use “we” in the body of your manuscript when it serves the purpose of inviting the reader into your process or acknowledging the contributions of others.
- Conjunctive adverbs (*however, therefore, etc.*) can be used in various locations in a sentence. If you use one of these adverbs or adverb phrases (*on the other hand, as a result, etc.*) to connect two independent clauses, you must use a semicolon at the end of the first clause and follow the conjunctive adverb/adverb phrase with a comma.
Example: The majority of the findings appeared to conflict with the researchers’ expectations; however, one result was surprisingly consistent.
- Subordinating adverbs, for example, *while, whereas, although, etc.*, introduce dependent clauses; the clauses they introduce are not complete sentences. Any clause beginning with a subordinating adverb must be connected to an independent clause.
Example: Whereas the initial findings were disappointing, subsequent experiments provided more promising results.

LEGAL AND ETHICAL ISSUES

The student is responsible for conducting research according to ethical standards and for using material in accordance with legal restrictions. The information in this chapter does not constitute legal advice. It describes the issues and alerts you to your obligations.

Accessibility

Complying with the [Web Content Accessibility Guidelines \(WCAG\) 2.1 Level AA](#), or later updated accessibility guidelines, is required.

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The patent statute provides that an invention or discovery involving "any new and useful process, machine, manufacture, or composition of matter, or any new and useful improvements thereof" may be patented. The intent of this broad definition is to include a device or material that an individual might be able to produce and the processes used to produce it.

Under University of Alabama Board of Trustees policy (supplemented by UAH policies), the institution owns all inventions conceived or developed by a researcher in the course of his/her employment at the university. In accordance with Board guidelines, the university determines whether ownership of an invention is assigned to the university. If it is, the university determinewhether it wishes to pursue patenting. The university and the inventor in accordance with the Board's formula share any income from licensing or sale of an invention patented by the university. The university (or other funding agency) may decide whether it wishes to retain ownership. Thus, even if the institution has first rights, it may choose to release the invention to the inventor to patent it or not as the individual desires. Similar rights to ownership may apply when an outside agency funds work.

You must consult the UAH patent administrator as soon as you believe you may have an invention, material, or process suitable for patent. Patent law requires strict record keeping, and it is especially stringent about timelines dating discovery or invention of an item or process suitable for patent, disclosing information about it, and applying for patent protection.

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Human Subjects

If your research requires any testing or surveying of human subjects, including anonymous surveys through professional organizations, you must demonstrate that your research design complies with the guidelines of the UAH Institutional Review Board (IRB). Begin the IRB approval process as early as possible.

All research involving human subjects must be approved by an Institutional Review Board (IRB). The Federal Government establishes special regulations (Title 45 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Part 46) to assure the safety of all human subjects involved in research. UAH and its IRB maintain a strong commitment to treating human subjects ethically and to following all federal regulations. IRB approval constitutes assurance that research involving human subjects meets these regulations and is designed to treat participants fairly and ethically.

You must begin by consulting the UAH IRB to confirm and document the level of review your research will require. The UAH IRB will determine, depending upon the nature of your research, whether your proposal requires a full review, an expedited review, or is exempt from review. A review is based on your research protocol included in a draft informed-consent document with supporting forms, such as survey instruments. **This initial review must be done for ALL research involving human subjects even if the research only uses anonymous surveys.** The UAH IRB review evaluates your proposal against federal guidelines for protecting the rights and welfare of a subject group, including issues of equitable selection, risk, safety, privacy, and informed consent.

You may obtain from the UAH Office of Counsel a document describing more fully the issues in using human subjects, essential elements for proposals and research designs, federal guidelines, and the criteria of the UAH IRB.

You **must** include, as appendices in your manuscript, a copy of survey or testing instruments **as well as the UAH IRB form** granting permission to conduct your research.

For more information, please review UAH's IRB webpage at <https://www.uah.edu/irb>.

Other Animal Subjects

If your experimental research involves using any animals, you must submit your research plan (or grant proposal) for review and approval to the UAH Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) before you use any animal subjects. Contact the Office of the Vice President for Research for the name of the current chair of the IACUC.

You should begin by consulting the Chair of the IACUC and obtaining an application form. In developing the research plan, you should work closely with your advisor (who may be listed as principal investigator). The IACUC can also provide you with government publications outlining your responsibilities in using animals.

You must conduct research in accordance with your approved proposal. If you change methods or procedures during the course of the project, you must submit a revised proposal. Throughout the project you are responsible for the care and well-being of the animals in your study.

You **must** include a **copy of the IACUC form** granting permission in your manuscript as an appendix.

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UAH is a publicly funded institution, and, as such, all theses, dissertations, and DNP projects must be accessible to the general public. The student is responsible for ensuring that no classified material appears in a thesis, dissertation, or DNP project. For special cases concerning proprietary information, please consult with the Graduate School.

The student should confer with the Research Advisor as early as possible to determine whether the proposed thesis, dissertation, or DNP project fulfills the requirement to be publicly accessible. If the

manuscript includes confidential information, choose one of the following options or consult with the Graduate School:

- Anonymize the information and only include disassociated data.
- Use a mock data set and analyze this data in the manuscript.
- If the tool is of primary importance, publish the tool without data sets.
- Redact the confidential information; this should only be done to a limited degree and with care to maintain the comprehensibility of the text.
- Confine the confidential information to an appendix that will remain unpublished.

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